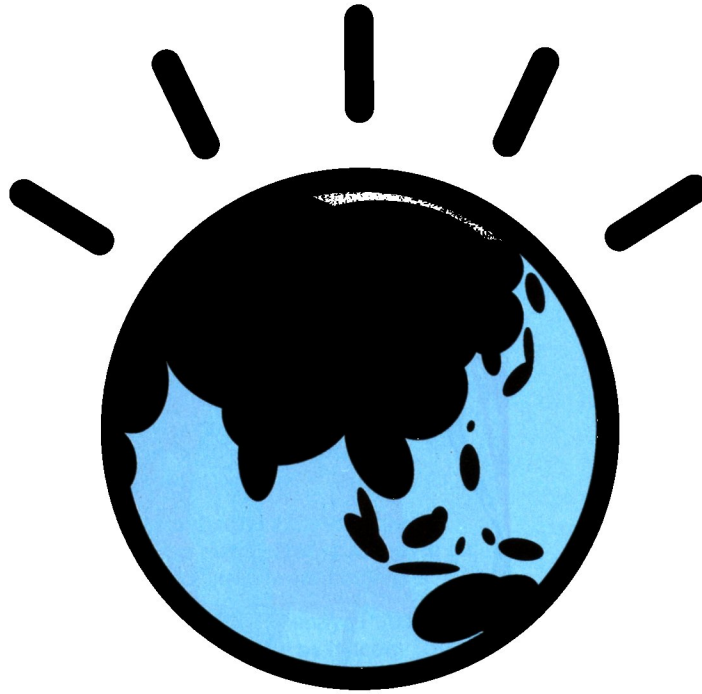




A mandate for change is a mandate for smart.

The mandate for change today is not merely for political leaders, but also for managers of businesses everywhere.

These volatile times have put the onus on businesses to focus on complex global systems now more than ever. And we have had an important learning from engaging in these systems: global integration impacts the way the world works.

We have also realized, as the world gets 'smaller' and 'flatter', merely being connected is not enough to survive, let alone thrive.

Fortunately, something is happening right now: our planet is becoming 'smarter'.

Here is how. With billions of inexpensive sensors being embedded inside everything, from trains and planes to livestock and medicines, our world is becoming instrumented, allowing systems and objects to 'speak' with each other. Linked to powerful backend systems, these instruments can analyze data and turn information into insights in real time, turning mere assets into intelligent assets.

With so much ready potential, what would you not change?

Consider these:

The second annual Global Retail Theft Barometer Survey across 36 countries in 2008 found that India has the highest shrinkage rate at 3.1% (that's about Rs. 12,392 crores in losses).

Over 87% of India's poorest households have no access to credit at all.

Owing to its unique geo-climatic conditions, India is highly prone to natural disasters. So much so, they cost the country 13% of its GDP today and will go on to become a major stumbling block to its economic growth by next year.

The good news is, on a smarter planet, these problems are solvable.

Now, consider these:

Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd. is now in the process of implementing a tracking system for its Liquefied Petroleum Gas cylinders from the bottling plant to its distributor network, using a Radio Frequency Identification (RFID) based solution, helping curb illegal diversions, while delivering an essential resource to consumers.

Financial Information Network and Operations Ltd., a technology solutions provider focusing on micro customers, is helping many of the nation's disadvantaged gain access to simple financial products to improve their quality of life.

While it cannot eradicate natural disasters or even reduce them, technology can certainly help mitigate losses and alleviate human suffering. Based on analysis of affected regions, relief agencies can be guided to manage people, resources and logistics in a far more efficient manner.

Clearly, there is a pressing mandate for change today. And we have the resources to get started. Log on to ibm.com/smarterplanet/in and be part of the revolution with IBM.

